GOLD STANDARD · VERBATIM DIET POSTER

NO REGULATORY BANNER — EXEMPT REPTILE
Outside USDA / TPWD jurisdiction. Husbandry per LIFE protocol.

[photo]

LEOPARD TORTOISE

Stigmochelys pardalis

GRAZING TORTOISE — Hay + Grasses + Limited Greens

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: Grazing tortoise — African savanna; STRICT GRAZER, NOT a Sulcata
SITES: Houston · San Antonio

3-SEC CHECK: Is grass hay dominant? Any fruit visible? (should be NONE)

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Whole hay pile. Fresh grass cut long. Coarse greens whole. Browse branches.

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

Single coarse green leaf or grass strand for hand-feeding. Drawn from daily allocation.

APPROX DAILY: Per posted portion chart

CORRECT 80% grass hay + grasses · 15% coarse greens · 5% browse · NO FRUIT

Timothy hay

Grass hay

Dandelion greens

Mulberry leaves

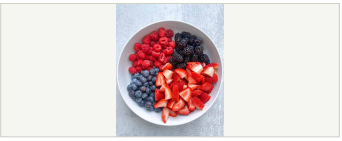
Browse branches

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY Fruit · Commercial tortoise pellets · High-protein greens (kale daily)

Banana

Apple

Mango


Berries

SIMPLE BUILD

- Grass hay + fresh grass dominant
- Coarse greens (dandelion, mulberry, collard) whole
- Browse branches

PREP RULE

Strict grazer. NO FRUIT. Differs from Sulcata in tolerating limited coarse greens.

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

POST AT EXHIBIT · DO NOT REMOVE · SUPERSEDES PRIOR DIET CARDS

Source: AZA Chelonian TAG · Sulcata/Leopard nutrition guidelines · Verbatim Gold Standard
LIFE Diet Governance System · Gold Standard v2026.04.25 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.